RANK-5	XLRI, JAMSHEDPUR
OVERALL SCORE	842.1
PLACEMENT PERFORMANCE	Recorded 100% placements with average package of ₹33 lakh for the batch that graduated in 2026
CAMPUS EXPERIENCE	The institute has earned international accreditation from AACSB, USA, EQUIS and Association of MBAs (AMBA), UK. It has partnerships with several Jesuit institutions all over the world
NEW INITIATIVES	• Has applied to become a university. Opened a new campus in Haryana's Jhajjar. Acquired a campus in Karjat, Maharashtra. Planning a new AI campus in Andhra Pradesh's Amaravati • Plans to explore different areas like science and technology, school of law and regulatory affairs, and healthcare management, and grant undergraduate degrees after getting deemed university status

education was still taking shape, corporate sustainability and ethics were part of XLRI's curriculum.

"XLRI develops this mindset to work for the greater good," says George.

Although XLRI Jamshedpur currently offers PGDM programmes, it has already applied to become a deemed-to-be university.

George says the institute has received a letter of intent from the ministry and wants to expand with more campuses. The plan includes opening another campus in Jamshedpur. "We have acquired one campus in Neral, Karjat (Maharashtra). As soon as we get the status of a university, we will begin our programmes there as well," he says, adding that the university status is expected within a year.

Aside from Jamshedpur, XLRI has ventured into NCR with a campus in Haryana's Jhajjar. It also plans to set up an AI-focused campus in Andhra Pradesh's Amaravati. "We want the Amaravati campus to be known for AI," says George.

With the university tag, XLRI will be able to offer MBA instead of PGDM. "Earlier, PGDM was well-accepted because IIMs were giving PGDMs. There was a lot of commonality among all institutions. Now, IIMs have started giving degrees. We are thinking that giving only PGDM may not help students in their further studies," says the XLRI director.

"Once we get the university status, the fellow programme would become PhD and PGDM would become MBA," he adds.

XLRI is among a few institutions that have been accredited with the triple crown: AMBA (Association of MBAs), AACSB (Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business) and EQUIS (EFMD Quality Improvement System). It has also ranked fifth in the *BT*-MDRA Best B-schools Survey 2026-27, with an overall score of 842.1.

According to George, XLRI wants to establish five schools and have at least 10 programmes once it receives university status.

The XLRI director is confident that a two-year management programme will continue to be relevant in India over the next decade.

"In Europe and the US, the one-year programme is becoming more relevant. But as far as India is concerned, a two-year programme is still relevant. But we don't know what happens 10 years down the line. That's anybody's guess," he adds.

Unlike IIMs, XLRI evaluates applicants through its own exam, XAT. Over 1,00,000 applicants appear each year.

"While CAT evaluates three components taught by coaching centres, XAT also looks at decision making, which requires raw intelligence," says George.

The average package for the batch that graduated in 2026 stood at ₹34 lakh for Business Management (BM) and ₹33 lakh for Human Resource Management (HRM).

In HRM, 180 students pass out each year. In BM, about 240 students graduate from the Jamshedpur campus.

The institute also takes about 40 research scholars every year. While most of the institute's 90 faculty members are from IIMs, George says attracting star faculty is difficult.

Most students get placed with consulting firms followed by the banking and financial sector. BT

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